

Tars Cunha

Product Designer

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tarscunha.com 🖥️

Boston, MA 📍

Highly versatile designer specializing in **UX for complex, high-scale technical platforms**. Proven ability to drive cross-functional alignment and roadmap execution for complex, 0-to-1 initiatives across consumer, enterprise, and developer platforms.

EXPERIENCE

Senior UX Designer

Google • Cambridge, MA • 2014-Present

Firestore (2021-Present): Created end-to-end UX for Gemini-powered developer tools in the Firestore Console and Studio, driving business impact across pre-release testing and observability products.

- Scale & Scope: Contributed to the design strategy for products used by over 3 million developers globally, collaborating with a cross-functional team of 30+ engineers and 4 PMs.
- Process & Tools: Defined user research plans, wireframed complex workflows in Figma, and delivered high-fidelity prototypes for pre-release testing and observability features (e.g., App Distribution and Crashlytics).
- Impact: Transformed Firestore App Distribution into a full-fledged testing tool by introducing automatic testing features to complement human testing, leading to the launch of Firestore's very first agent in the console, the **App Testing Agent**.

Google Ads (2018-2021): Developed results-oriented, information-dense user interfaces for the campaign management tools used by enterprise clients in the travel industry.

- Scale & Scope: Supported a product used by hundreds of thousands of high-value advertising clients, directly contributing to a multi-billion dollar revenue stream.
- Process & Tools: Strategized and collaborated with researchers to execute usability studies and A/B tests to validate design decisions on high-traffic UI components and patterns.
- Impact: Architected a user-centered solution to activate supplier coverage for connected hotels, recapturing 5% of matched impressions and securing significant revenue opportunities.

Google Ink (2015-2018): Led design and research as the sole UX specialist to integrate drawing/annotation functionality into high-profile consumer products like Google Keep, Classroom, and Canvas.

- Scope & Autonomy: Functioned as the solo UX professional for a cross-functional team (10+ people), driving the product's roadmap from incubation to market delivery.
- Process & Tools: Conducted foundational user research to define core user needs, then prototyped, tested and closely partnered with cross-organizational teams to ship integration solutions for several products.
- Impact: Successful integrations shipped the core drawing/annotation feature to products serving hundreds of millions of monthly active users, significantly expanding their functionality.

Google Charts (2014-2015): Defined Data Visualization specifications for the Material Design system, impacting millions of users across the Google product suite.

- Scope: The published specifications guided the creation of consistent charts across numerous Google products, including Google Sheets, Google Analytics, and Google Charts itself.
- Process: Collaborated with multiple internal design teams (ACUX, GViz) to define visual and interaction guidelines for typography, color, and spacing.
- Standardization: Ensured specifications met strict Internationalization standards and Google Accessibility Requirements (GAR), covering color contrast, screen reader compatibility, and keyboard navigation.

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & Lead Designer

Vectra Creative • Cambridge, MA • 2011-2014

Managed all business operations, including client relations and hiring, while acting as the primary UX and Visual Designer to deliver finalized branding and web solutions.

Freelance Graphic Designer

Self-employed • Somerville, MA • 2009-2011

Secured and executed short-term design contracts for clients like Stonyfield Farm, Gemvara, and Cramer, delivering marketing collateral, branding assets, and digital design services.

Advertising Designer

Allen Roche Group • Somerville, MA • 2010-2011

Conceptualized original campaigns for print and digital ads, and contributed to managing ad trafficking and the print production pipeline.

In-House Print Designer

Central Steel Supply • Somerville, MA • 2004-2010

Produced all internal promotional materials (e.g., flyers, brochures) and modeled complex mechanical parts for fabrication using AUTOCAD software.

Design Intern

Carisma Advertising • Winchester, MA • 2008-2009

Designed and updated original artwork for a high-volume flow of advertising materials supporting automotive dealerships across New England.

EDUCATION

Associates in Graphic Design

Middlesex Community College • Bedford, MA • 2006-2009

SKILLS & TOOLS

Design & Prototyping

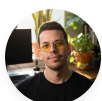
Figma
Sketch
Adobe Creative Suite
Design Systems
Data Visualization
Design Sprints

Research & Strategy

A/B Testing
Usability Studies
Research Planning
Customer Interviews
Cross-functional Alignment
Workshop Facilitation

Technical Fluency

HTML
CSS
JS
Git
IDEs (VS Code)
Vibe Coding Tools
(Firebase Studio, GitHub Copilot, Cursor)



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